

ACME CORPORATION

Benefits Enrollment Process Guide

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1. Enrollment Types

Enrollment Type	When	Window	Override Required
Open Enrollment	Annual / Nov 1-30	30 days	No
New Hire Enrollment	Within 30 days of hire	30 days	No
Life Event Enrollment	Within 30 days of event	30 days	No
Late Enrollment	Outside any window	N/A	HR Director approval
COBRA Continuation	Within 60 days of qualifying event	60 days	No

2. Enrollment Workflow Steps

The standard 8-step enrollment process:

- Step 1: Eligibility Verification -- System confirms employee meets all eligibility rules
- Step 2: Plan Selection -- Employee selects medical, dental, vision plans
- Step 3: Coverage Tier Selection -- Employee selects tier (EE only, EE+Spouse, etc.)
- Step 4: Dependent Addition -- Employee adds and verifies eligible dependents
- Step 5: Life Insurance Selection -- Basic auto-enrolled; voluntary options presented
- Step 6: Disability Coverage -- STD/LTD options with cost calculator
- Step 7: Cost Review -- Employee reviews total monthly and per-paycheck costs
- Step 8: Confirmation -- Employee confirms elections; system locks enrollment

3. Default Coverage Rules

Employees who do not actively enroll during open enrollment or the new hire window will be automatically enrolled in the following default plans:

Benefit Type	Default Plan	Default Tier
Medical	PPO 500 (MED-PPO-500)	Employee Only
Dental	Dental Basic (DEN-BASIC)	Employee Only
Vision	Vision Standard (VIS-STD)	Employee Only
Basic Life	LIFE-BASIC (1x salary)	Automatic
Voluntary Life	Not enrolled	N/A
STD/LTD	Employer-paid portion only	N/A

(AI DEMO: Default plan is now explicitly defined. AI should link this to the ambiguous statements in Benefits Guide Section 9 and Eligibility Policy Section 7.)

4. Status Lifecycle

Status	Meaning	Next State
Pending	Employee has started but not submitted e	Submitted
Submitted	Elections submitted, awaiting HR review	Approved / Rejected
Approved	HR has approved enrollment, carrier file	Active
Active	Coverage is in force, deductions running	Terminated / Changed
Rejected	HR rejected due to missing docs or eligi	Pending
Terminated	Coverage ended due to termination or vol	N/A
Waived	Employee actively waived coverage	Open Enrollment eligible

5. Life Event Processing

When an employee experiences a qualifying life event:

- Employee submits life event notification in the Benefits Portal
- System opens a 30-day enrollment window from the event date
- Employee submits supporting documentation within the window
- HR reviews and approves documentation
- Enrollment changes are processed and sent to carriers
- Payroll deductions are updated before the next payroll cycle

AI Validation: The AI assistant will review the submitted life event details, verify documentation requirements, and confirm eligibility for the requested changes.

6. Carrier File Generation

Upon approval of enrollment or life event changes:

- Benefits platform generates carrier transaction file
- Transaction includes all required fields per carrier specification
- File is transmitted according to carrier schedule
- Carrier acknowledgment is received and logged
- Rejected transactions are flagged for manual review

Integration Reference: See Acme_Carrier_Requirements.pdf for complete field specifications.

7. Audit Requirements

All enrollment actions must be logged with the following information:

- Timestamp of action
- User or system that performed the action
- Previous values and new values (for changes)
- Reason for change (for life events and administrative overrides)

Audit logs must be retained for a minimum of 7 years per ERISA requirements.